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AQA · LEVEL 1 · ENGLISH READING

AQA Functional Skills English Reading Level 1

January 2020 - Reading Paper · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 30 / 30 Marks (100%) Pass Mark Guide: ~65%

Specification / Paper Code: AQA-Functional-Skills-English-Level-1-January-2020-Reading

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

Verified by Tutor Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)
Centre Name:	Master Functional Skills (MFS01)
Lead Tutor:	Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk
Edition:	2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)

- Complete Source Insert Included
- Built Cleanly on Empty AQA Question Paper
- Verified 100% Against Official AQA Mark Scheme

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AQA

Functional Skills Level 1
ENGLISH

Paper 1 Reading

Insert

The three sources that follow are:

Source A: a letter to the local Council
Source B: a factsheet about getting a cat
Source C: an advertisement for a cattery

Please open the Insert fully to see all three sources

Source A

Housing Department Manager
Southampton City Council

Dear Sir

Apparently, there are 11.1 million cats in the UK and I think most of them visit my garden, bringing their fleas with them! I need the council to do something about this problem.

Cats are a nuisance. They leave their mess in other people's gardens and their owners do not seem to care at all. I am a dedicated gardener and I am fed up of standing in cat mess or, even worse, putting my hand in it! This causes a serious health risk to myself and my grandchildren who sometimes play in my garden. Cats can trigger an asthma attack and I worry about my four-year-old grandson who suffers from asthma.

All cats dig to bury their mess but I hate it when a cat digs in my vegetable plot. Sometimes they disturb the seeds or pull out my young strawberry plants.

Cats may look cute, but they should be kept indoors and their owners should be held responsible if the cat gets out. I took this photograph and spoke to my neighbours about the problem but they just say "Oh, it's impossible to keep him in."

It is really unfair that I have to tolerate this and I would like to know what the council can do to help.

Yours faithfully

Mrs P Barkley



Source B

Thinking of getting a cat?

Some people want a cat to cuddle and sit on their lap. Others are happy to live with a very independent cat which spends most of its time outside and doesn't want too much fuss. Whichever of these is for you, you will find great love and joy in your cat companion.



"Do all cats hunt?"

You may hate the idea of your cat hunting outside. Perhaps you are a bird lover, or simply don't fancy a gift of a small dead mouse. Hunting is normal behaviour for cats. But if you want a cat to keep rats away, you won't want to find yourself with a couch potato cat!

"Can I keep a cat indoors?"

Being outdoors brings a huge variety to a cat's life and allows it to use all its hunting behaviours. Of course there are risks outside for cats, but cats also need space to run around and express natural behaviour.

"Can I keep a cat on vegetarian food?"

If you really want a vegetarian pet, get a rabbit – a cat needs some of the nutrients found in meat. It would be unfair and dangerous to its health to keep it as a vegetarian.

Your cat needs:

- plenty of human companionship
- regular meals with a constant supply of fresh water
- a clean and comfortable bed
- regular grooming
- outdoor access or a litter tray
- a safe, stimulating environment.

Source C



CALLING ALL CHOOSY CATS!

Do you need a holiday from your owners?

Then get your humans to check out Cranborne Cattery.

Our friendly family business provides a top-class, personal service. If you live locally, we can collect and deliver your cat free of charge. Why not visit us and take a tour? Your precious puss will love the high standard of our accommodation.

We offer roomy cat runs measuring 2.1 metres × 1.8 metres, which are licensed to hold up to three cats. Each run contains a cosy, heated sleeping box. Outside, there's space for your cat to explore, hide or simply stretch out in the sun. We want your cat to feel at home with us, so you are welcome to bring favourite bedding or fleeces, scratchers and other toys.

The owner, David Simpson, has previously worked in various other catteries and is skilled in administering medication. We also offer a variety of different menu choices.

DAILY TARIFF FROM 1ST JANUARY 2020

1 cat – £12.50

2 cats – £23.00

3 cats – £30.00

Minimum charge: our minimum charge is 3 days or £38, whichever is higher.

Unfortunately, debit and credit card payments cannot be processed.

END OF SOURCES

There are no sources printed on this page

Open out this page to see
Source B and Source C

There are no sources printed on this page

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Section A

Read **Source A** and answer **Questions 1** to **6**.

0 1 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement about Mrs Barkley is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
She thinks there is nothing worse than standing in cat mess.		
She has more than one grandchild.		
She grows her own fruit.		
Her neighbours don't speak to her.		

Using the information in Source A, put a tick (□) in the correct box to show whether each

[2 marks]

0 2 You may use a dictionary for this question.

In Source A Mrs Barkley says, "It is really unfair that I have to tolerate this..."

In this quotation the word 'tolerate' means…

A write about.
B complain about.
C put up with.
D explain.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

0 3 **Source A** contains text and a picture.

What **extra** information does the picture suggest?

A Cats like to hide.
B Cats like to dig.
C Cats don't like humans.
D Cats carry fleas.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Level of response mark schemes are broken down into levels, each of which has a descriptor. The

Answer

[1 mark]

descriptor for the level shows the average performance for the level. There are marks in each level.

Question 3 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

Before you apply the mark scheme to a learner's answer, read through the answer and annotate it (as instructed) to show the qualities that are being looked for. You can then apply the mark scheme.

Step 1 Determine a level

Start by reading the whole of the learner's response and then, using the mark scheme level descriptors and the standardisation scripts, place the response in the level which it matches or best fits.

[1 mark]

Question 1 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

statement about Mrs Barkley is true or false.

She thinks there is nothing worse than standing in cat mess.

☐

She has more than one grandchild.

☐

She grows her own fruit.

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

0 4 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement about cats is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
There are 11.1 billion cats in the UK.		
Cats dig in gardens.		
Cats can cause an asthma attack.		
Cats like vegetables.		

[2 marks]

0 5 You may use a dictionary for this question.

Source A states that Mrs Barkley is 'a dedicated gardener'.

In this quotation the word 'dedicated' means…

A skilled.
B qualified.
C relaxed.
D keen.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

0 6 The writing in **Source A** mainly

A explains how the Council can help Mrs Barkley.
B tells the Council how to help Mrs Barkley.
C persuades the Council to help Mrs Barkley.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Correct answer per official AQA mark scheme (1 mark).
[1 mark]

Answer

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

Read **Source B** and answer **Questions 7** to **9**.

0 7 In **Source B**, identify **one** positive thing and **one** negative thing about owning a cat.

0 7 . 1 Positive thing _____

Correct answer per official AQA mark scheme (1 mark).
[1 mark]

[1 mark]

0 7 . 2 Negative thing _____

[1 mark]

0 8 **Source B** tells us a cat needs 'a safe, stimulating environment'.

What does the phrase 'stimulating environment' tell us about cats?

A They like lots of routine.
B They need a variety of activities.
C They need a quiet place to rest.
D They like to take risks.

Section B Question
[1 mark]

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

0 9 **Source B** uses subheadings.

What is the purpose of the speech marks in these subheadings?

A to ask permission to keep a cat in the house
B to show that these are unusual questions
C to ask for advice on how to feed a cat
D to make the text seem like a conversation *[Correct: D - 1 mark]*

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

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Questions 10 and **11** refer to **Source A** and **Source B**.

1 0 Identify **two** similarities between **Source A** and **Source B**.

You might want to look at:

- the format and layout
- the language used
- the kind of information, ideas and opinions given in the texts.

[2 marks]

Similarity 1 _____

_____

Similarity 2 _____

_____

1 1 Identify **two** differences between **Source A** and **Source B**.

You might want to look at:

- the format and layout
- the language used
- the kind of information, ideas and opinions given in the texts.

[2 marks]

Difference 1 _____

_____

Difference 2 _____

_____

16

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Section B

Read **Source C** and answer **Questions 12** to **17**.

1 2 Look at the language and structure used in **Source C**.

The main purpose of **Source C** is to:

A explain the history of Cranborne Cattery.
B persuade cat owners to use Cranborne Cattery.
C describe the facilities at Cranborne Cattery.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

1 3 You may use a dictionary for this question.

Source C states that David Simpson is 'skilled in administering medication.'

In this quotation the word 'administering' means…

A buying.
B making.
C checking.
D giving.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

1 4 What does 'our minimum charge is 3 days or £38, whichever is higher' mean?

A You must pay at least £38.
B You cannot leave your cat there for more than three days.
C You will pay less than £38.
D You must leave your cat there for three days.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

1 5 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
There is no charge for cats to be collected in the local area.		
David Simpson runs the business on his own.		
The cats are provided with a warm place to sleep.		
No more than three cats can stay in the same run.		

[2 marks]

1 6 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **fact** or **opinion**.

	Fact	Opinion
Our service is top-class and personal.		
The pens are 2.1 metres by 1.8 metres.		
A variety of different menu choices is available.		
Debit and credit card payments cannot be processed.		

[2 marks]

Turn over for the next question

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1 7 An elderly relative needs a place to look after her cat while she is away for a week. She has asked you to help her find somewhere suitable.

Make a list of the **important points** your relative would need to know about placing a cat in Cranborne Cattery.

[3 marks]

10

END OF QUESTIONS

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There are no questions printed on this page

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ANSWER IN THE SPACES PROVIDED

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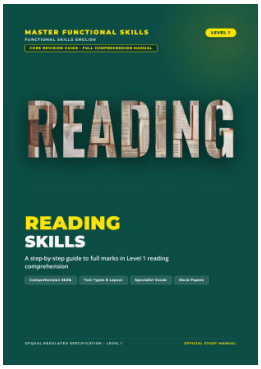
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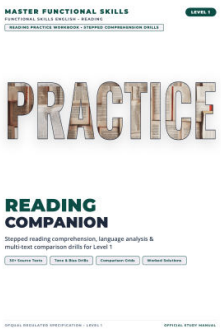


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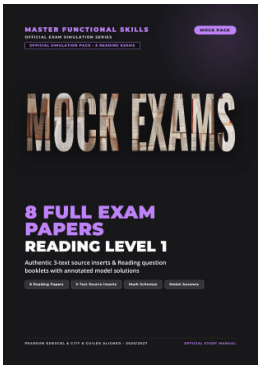


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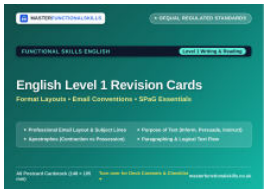


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